PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

International Scout 80 / 800

1961–1971 · Scout 80 · 800 · 800A · 800B

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Rust is the whole story**
  Autotrader Classics says to check the rockers, the windshield and side-window frames, and the lower corners of the removable top. Silodrome adds the spring mounts, the insides of the fenders and the welds, and warns that rust starts on the inside and works out, so bubbling paint is a bad sign. The fact that IH Parts America sells front and rear floors, inner and outer rockers, and fuel-tank compartment panels tells you where else to look.

- [ ] **Count the big panels**
  Small steel parts are widely reproduced, but Autotrader Classics notes that no one makes large panels such as fenders. A truck that needs fenders is a much bigger job than one that only needs floors.

- [ ] **Is it really a 4×4?**
  Scouts were sold in two-wheel drive too. Autotrader's quick test: if the hub sticks out through the hub cap, it's a four-wheel-drive truck. Then look for the twin transfer-case levers.

- [ ] **Confirm the year and the engine**
  Binder Planet hosts Jim Allen's list of starting and ending serial numbers for the 80, 800, 800A and 800B, compiled from IHC records, so you can date the truck and confirm which model it is. On an IH V8, Super Scout Specialists says the displacement is stamped on a domino-sized flat spot on the right side of the block, toward the front and just below the head. Engine swaps are common.

- [ ] **Listen to the driveline**
  Autotrader Classics advises checking the axles and transfer case for wear. A transfer case that pops out of gear needs to come out for a rebuild, according to an IH Parts America moderator. On the front axle, look for worn knuckle wipers and sloppy kingpins.

- [ ] **Power options matter**
  Silodrome says Scouts with both power steering and power brakes are the better buy, because without them steering and braking take real effort. Autotrader Classics calls the four-wheel drums archaic and says a four-cylinder probably won't reach 75 mph.

- [ ] **Ask what's been changed**
  Suspension and other modifications are common, so ask the seller for details. That includes lifts, shackle swaps, disc conversions and engine transplants. A good conversion can be a plus. An undocumented one is a list of questions.

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **80 or 800**
  Scout 80s have the IH logo in the centre of the grille and tailgate, vacuum wipers at the top of a fold-down windshield, and hooks on the tailgate. The 800 moved the IH badge to the hood and got an 'International' grille nameplate, push-button door handles and a tailgate without hooks. 800A grilles have three pieces with matte-black headlight bezels; the 800B's bezels are chrome.

- [ ] **The '1965½' Scout**
  About 3,000 Scouts built in late 1965 with leftover 80 parts are 800s by VIN and line-setting ticket. They still have the 80's hood tie-down loop and wire-mesh grille with a gold IH emblem.

- [ ] **Chassis serial ranges**
  Super Scout Specialists' parts-catalogue ranges: Scout 80 serials run FC501 (1961) to FC124894 (1965), with FC150000–FC160573 for 1965–66. Scout 800 uses the G prefix (1966–68). 800A/800B serials run from G329142 (1969) to G445189 (1971).

- [ ] **Axles**
  Early trucks use Dana 27 front and rear, with the diffs offset to the passenger side to line up with the Dana 18 transfer case. From the 800A, the rear is a centred Dana 44 with a Dana 20 transfer case. Some transition trucks mix parts and run an angled rear driveshaft. The Dana 27's axle shafts are prone to breaking off-road, so check what's under yours.

- [ ] **Line ticket**
  The factory line ticket lists engine, transmission, axles, gear ratio and paint codes. Axle ratio tags often rusted off, so the line ticket is the reliable way to confirm ratios and Power-Lock limited-slip diffs.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/scout/scout-80-800/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks